

Hon. Kymberly K. Evanson

Presented to the Court by the foreman of the
Grand Jury in open Court, in the presence of
the Grand Jury and FILED in the U.S.
DISTRICT COURT at Seattle, Washington.

April 28 20 26
By Joshua C. Lewis Deputy

UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT FOR THE
WESTERN DISTRICT OF WASHINGTON
AT SEATTLE

UNITED STATES OF AMERICA,

Plaintiff,

v.

LEANTHONY PALMER,

Defendant.

NO. CR25-206-KKE

SUPERSEDING INDICTMENT

The Grand Jury charges that:

COUNT 1

(Conspiracy to Commit Sex Trafficking by Force, Fraud, and Coercion)

Beginning on a date unknown, and continuing until on or about November 24,
2025, in King County, within the Western District of Washington, and elsewhere,
LEANTHONY PALMER, and others known and unknown, knowingly conspired and
agreed, in and affecting interstate commerce, to recruit, entice, harbor, transport, provide,
obtain, and maintain, by any means, adult females, knowing and with reckless disregard
of the fact that force, threats of force, fraud, and coercion, and any combination of such
means, would be used to cause those adult females to engage in a commercial sex act.

All in violation of Title 18, United States Code, Sections 1591(a)(1) and 1594(c).

COUNT 2

(Sex Trafficking of an Adult Female (AF3) by Force, Fraud, and Coercion)

Beginning in or about 2023, and continuing until on or about March 23, 2024, in King County, within the Western District of Washington, and elsewhere, LEANTHONY PALMER did knowingly, in and affecting interstate commerce, recruit, entice, harbor, transport, provide, obtain, and maintain, by any means, an adult female, AF3, knowing and with reckless disregard of the fact that force, threats of force, fraud, and coercion, and any combination of such means, would be used to cause AF3 to engage in a commercial sex act.

The Grand Jury further alleges this offense was committed during and in furtherance of the Conspiracy to Commit Sex Trafficking by Force, Fraud, and Coercion charged in Count 1.

All in violation of Title 18, United States Code, Sections 1591(a)(1) and (b)(1).

COUNT 3

(Sex Trafficking of an Adult Female (AF1) by Force, Fraud, and Coercion)

Beginning in or about 2023, and continuing until on or about March 20, 2025, in King County, within the Western District of Washington, and elsewhere, LEANTHONY PALMER did knowingly, in and affecting interstate commerce, recruit, entice, harbor, transport, provide, obtain, and maintain, by any means, an adult female, AF1, knowing and with reckless disregard of the fact that force, threats of force, fraud, and coercion, and any combination of such means, would be used to cause AF1 to engage in a commercial sex act.

The Grand Jury further alleges this offense was committed during and in furtherance of the Conspiracy to Commit Sex Trafficking by Force, Fraud, and Coercion charged in Count 1.

All in violation of Title 18, United States Code, Sections 1591(a)(1) and (b)(1).

COUNT 4

(Sex Trafficking of an Adult Female (AF2) by Force, Fraud, and Coercion)

Beginning in or about May 2025, and continuing until in or about November 24, 2025, in King County, within the Western District of Washington, and elsewhere, LEANTHONY PALMER did knowingly, in and affecting interstate commerce, recruit, entice, harbor, transport, provide, obtain, and maintain, and did aid and abet the same, by any means, an adult female, AF2, knowing and with reckless disregard of the fact that force, threats of force, fraud, and coercion, and any combination of such means, would be used to cause AF2 to engage in a commercial sex act.

The Grand Jury further alleges this offense was committed during and in furtherance of the Conspiracy to Commit Sex Trafficking by Force, Fraud, and Coercion charged in Count 1.

All in violation of Title 18, United States Code, Sections 1591(a)(1) and (b)(1), and 2.

COUNT 5

(Conspiracy to Transport Adult Women for Prostitution)

Beginning on a date unknown and continuing through November 24, 2025, in King County, within the Western District of Washington, and elsewhere, LEANTHONY PALMER, and others known and unknown, did knowingly conspire and agree to:

a. Transport individuals in interstate and foreign commerce, with intent that such individuals engage in prostitution and any sexual activity for which a person can be charged with a criminal offense in violation of Title 18, United States Code, Section 2421; and

b. Persuade, induce, entice, and coerce individuals to travel in interstate and foreign commerce with intent that such individuals engage in prostitution and any sexual activity for which any person can be charged with a criminal offense, in violation of Title

1 18, United States Code, Section 2422(a).

2 A. Object of the Conspiracy:

3 It was an object of the conspiracy to profit financially from the prostitution
4 activities of adult females in the States of Washington, Alaska, Oregon, California,
5 Colorado, Hawaii, Idaho, Nevada, Massachusetts, Montana, Minnesota, Texas, and
6 elsewhere, including foreign countries.

7 B. Manner and Means of the Conspiracy:

8 The manner and means by which the members of the conspiracy sought to
9 accomplish the object and purpose of the conspiracy included, among others, the
10 following:

11 1. It was part of the conspiracy that the co-conspirators recruited young
12 women to work as sex workers through the promise of protection, money, and other items
13 of value;

14 2. It was part of the conspiracy that the co-conspirators purchased sex workers
15 from other human traffickers and unnamed co-conspirators and transported them to
16 Washington;

17 3. It was part of the conspiracy that the co-conspirators purchased lingerie and
18 other sex related objects such as condoms, lubricant and sex toys for the sex workers to
19 use with potential clients;

20 4. It was part of the conspiracy for the co-conspirators to take photographs of
21 the sex workers wearing the lingerie in sexual poses, which they then posted in online
22 sex-advertisements to entice potential sex customers;

23 5. It was part of the conspiracy that the co-conspirators sent the sex workers to
24 Aurora Avenue and other locations in Seattle, and elsewhere, for the purpose of
25 recruiting potential commercial sex customers;

26 6. It was part of the conspiracy that the co-conspirators trained the sex
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1 workers on how to recruit potential customers and accompanied the sex workers both to
2 Aurora Avenue and elsewhere as they attempted to recruit potential customers, and
3 accompanied them to the eventual location of the commercial sex act with the potential
4 customer;

5 7. It was part of the conspiracy for the co-conspirators to set rules for their sex
6 workers including where they could go, who they could talk to, how much to charge for
7 specific sex acts, and a daily quota of how much money they had to earn each day;

8 8. It was part of the conspiracy that the co-conspirators used the funds earned
9 from the women's commercial sex acts to, among other things, pay for transportation
10 within and between states and foreign countries for sex work, post advertisements for sex
11 work, and pay for hotels for sex work;

12 9. It was part of the conspiracy that the co-conspirators caused women to
13 travel within and between the States of Washington, Alaska, Oregon, California,
14 Colorado, Hawaii, Idaho, Nevada, Massachusetts, Montana, Minnesota, Texas, and other
15 foreign countries to engage in commercial sex;

16 10. It was part of the conspiracy that the co-conspirators obtained hotel rooms
17 that were off the hotel books in SeaTac, Washington, and elsewhere. These hotel rooms
18 were used both as a location for potential sex acts with customers and as a location for
19 the conspiracy to house various sex workers;

20 11. It was part of the conspiracy for the co-conspirators to use the threat of
21 eviction from the hotel and withholding food as a means of controlling the sex workers
22 and enticing them to continue to conduct commercial sex acts;

23 12. It was part of the conspiracy for the co-conspirators to create false identities
24 both for themselves and for the sex workers under their control to enable interstate travel
25 and to avoid detection by law enforcement;

26 13. It was part of the conspiracy for the co-conspirators to use violence and the
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1 threat of violence to force sex workers to continue to engage in commercial sex acts and
2 recruit additional customers;

3 14. It was part of the conspiracy for the co-conspirators to provide controlled
4 substances to the sex-workers and then to deny them access to the controlled substances
5 if they did not follow their rules; and

6 15. It was part of the conspiracy for the co-conspirators to use false identities to
7 fraudulently obtain rental properties and vehicles that they used to further the conspiracy
8 to conduct sex trafficking.

9 C. Overt Acts:

10 During and in furtherance of the conspiracy, in the Western District of
11 Washington, and elsewhere, the co-conspirators committed the acts charged in Counts 6,
12 7, and 8, below, as overt acts.

13 All in violation of Title 18, United States Code, Section 371.

14 **COUNT 6**

15 **(Transportation of an Adult Female (AF3) for the Purpose of Prostitution Through**
16 **Coercion and Enticement)**

17 Beginning in or about 2022, and continuing until on or about March 23, 2024, in
18 King County, within the Western District of Washington, and elsewhere, LEANTHONY
19 PALMER did knowingly persuade, induce, entice, and coerce an adult female, AF3, to
20 travel in interstate commerce, specifically, to and from the States of California,
21 Washington, Nevada, and elsewhere, to engage in prostitution and any sexual activity for
22 which any person can be charged with a criminal offense.

23 The Grand Jury further alleges this offense was committed during and in
24 furtherance of the Conspiracy to Transport Adult Women for Prostitution charged in
25 Count 5.

26 All in violation of Title 18, United States Code, Sections 2422(a) and 2.
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COUNT 7

**(Transportation of an Adult Female (AF1) for the Purpose of Prostitution Through
Coercion and Enticement)**

Beginning in or about 2023, and continuing until on or about March 20, 2025, in King County, within the Western District of Washington, and elsewhere, LEANTHONY PALMER did knowingly persuade, induce, entice, and coerce an adult female, AF1, to travel in interstate commerce, specifically, to and from the States of Washington, Massachusetts, Nevada, and elsewhere, to engage in prostitution and any sexual activity for which any person can be charged with a criminal offense.

The Grand Jury further alleges this offense was committed during and in furtherance of the Conspiracy to Transport Adult Women for Prostitution charged in Count 5.

All in violation of Title 18, United States Code, Sections 2422(a) and 2.

COUNT 8

**(Transportation of an Adult Female (AF2) for the Purpose of Prostitution Through
Coercion and Enticement)**

Beginning in or about May 2025, and continuing until on or about November 24, 2025, in King County, within the Western District of Washington, and elsewhere, LEANTHONY PALMER did knowingly persuade, induce, entice, and coerce, and did aid and abet the same, an adult female, AF2, to travel in interstate commerce, specifically, to and from the States of Texas, California, Washington, Oregon, and elsewhere, to engage in prostitution and any sexual activity for which any person can be charged with a criminal offense.

The Grand Jury further alleges this offense was committed during and in furtherance of the Conspiracy to Transport Adult Women for Prostitution charged in Count 5.

1 All in violation of Title 18, United States Code, Sections 2422(a) and 2.

2 **COUNT 9**

3 **(Conspiracy to Commit Money Laundering)**

4 Beginning at a time unknown, and continuing until at least October 8, 2025, in
5 King, Pierce, Snohomish, and Whatcom Counties, within the Western District of
6 Washington, and elsewhere, LEANTHONY PALMER, and others known and unknown,
7 did knowingly combine, conspire, and agree with each other, and with other persons
8 known and unknown to the Grand Jury, to commit certain money laundering offenses
9 under Title 18, United States Code, Section 1956, as follows:

10 To knowingly conduct and attempt to conduct financial transactions, which
11 transactions involved the proceeds of specified unlawful activity, that is, Conspiracy to
12 Commit Sex Trafficking by Force, Fraud, and Coercion as charged in Count 1, Sex
13 Trafficking of an Adult Female by Force, Fraud and Coercion, as charged in Counts 2, 3,
14 and 4, Conspiracy to Transport Females for Prostitution as charged in Count 5, and
15 Transportation of an Adult Female for the Purpose of Prostitution, as charged in Counts
16 6, 7, and 8, knowing that the transactions were designed in whole or in part to conceal
17 and disguise the nature, location, source, ownership, and control of the proceeds of
18 specified unlawful activity, and that while conducting and attempting to conduct such
19 financial transactions, knew that the property involved in the financial transactions
20 represented the proceeds of some form of unlawful activity.

21 The Grand Jury further alleges this offense was committed during and in
22 furtherance of the Conspiracy to Commit Sex Trafficking by Force charged in Count 1
23 and the Conspiracy to Transport Adult Women for Prostitution charged in Count 5.

24 All in violation of Title 18, United States Code, Sections 1956(a)(1)(B)(i) and (h).

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FORFEITURE ALLEGATION

The allegations in Counts 1 through 9 of this Superseding Indictment are hereby realleged and incorporated by reference for the purpose of alleging forfeiture.

Upon conviction of any of the offenses charged in Counts 1, 2, 3, and 4 of this Superseding Indictment, LEANTHONY PALMER shall forfeit to the United States, pursuant to Title 18, United States Codes, Section 1594(d), any property that constitutes or is derived from proceeds of the offense and any property traceable to such property, as well as any property involved in, used, or intended to be used to commit or facilitate commission of the offense and any property traceable to such property.

Upon conviction of any of the offenses charged in Counts 5, 6, 7, and 8 of this Superseding Indictment, LEANTHONY PALMER shall forfeit to the United States, pursuant to Title 18, United States Code, Section 2428(a), any property that constitutes or is derived from proceeds of the offense, as well as any property used or intended to be used to commit or facilitate the offense.

Upon conviction of the offense alleged in Count 9, LEANTHONY PALMER shall forfeit to the United States, pursuant to Title 18, United States Code, Section 982(a)(1), any property involved in, or traceable to property involved in, the offense.

Substitute Assets. If any of the above-described forfeitable property, as a result of any act or omission of the defendant,

- a. cannot be located upon the exercise of due diligence;
- b. has been transferred or sold to, or deposited with, a third party;
- c. has been placed beyond the jurisdiction of the Court;
- d. has been substantially diminished in value; or,
- e. has been commingled with other property which cannot be divided without difficulty,

1 it is the intent of the United States to seek the forfeiture of any other property of the
2 defendant, up to the value of the above-described forfeitable property, pursuant to
3 Title 21, United States Code, Section 853(p).

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5 A TRUE BILL:

6 DATED: 4/28/2026

7 *Signature of Foreperson redacted pursuant*
8 *to the policy of the Judicial Conference of*
9 *the United States.*

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11
12 FOREPERSON

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14
15 SARAH Y. VOGEL
16 Criminal Chief Assistant United States Attorney

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19 TODD GREENBERG
20 Assistant United States Attorney

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